5.5 Craniotomy

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Drowsy after the operation **Objective** • GCS 13 • Dressing on the head • Pupils equal and reactive	**ACTUAL** **Decreased intracranial adaptive capacity** related to surgical edema as evidenced by reduced GCS after surgery.	Within 24 hours, GCS stable or improving.	• At first, check GCS, pupils and limb power every hour. • Position as the surgeon has ordered. • Watch the drain output and the dressing. • Give the anticonvulsant and steroid as prescribed.	GCS improving: **goal met**.
Subjective • "My head hurts." **Objective** • Pain 6/10 • Frowning, does not want to move	**ACTUAL** **Acute pain** related to surgical incision as evidenced by reported headache.	Pain 3/10 or less within 1 hour of analgesia.	• Give analgesia as prescribed and check again. • Keep the room quiet and dim. • If he finds it comfortable, put a cold compress on his forehead. • A sudden, severe headache must be reported (could be bleeding).	Pain controlled: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Surgical wound • Drain in situ	**RISK** **Risk for surgical site infection** as evidenced by risk factors: open cranial surgery and drain.	No signs of infection and no CSF leak.	• Aseptic technique for wound care. • Watch for clear fluid coming from the wound or the nose. • Check temperature and neck stiffness.	Wound clean: **goal met**.